

navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall

Now, select the key that corresponds to the Update uninstall information that you want to delete, and delete it.

Another way to do this would be to select the update in the Add/Remove Programs list and clicking Remove.

Since you have already deleted the Uninstall information, it's obvious that you will get an error message that tells you that the update cannot be uninstalled, and you'll get the option to remove the entry from the Add/Remove Programs list. Just click OK and the entry will be removed.

Remember to check the Show updates box so you can see the installed updates in Add/Remove Programs.

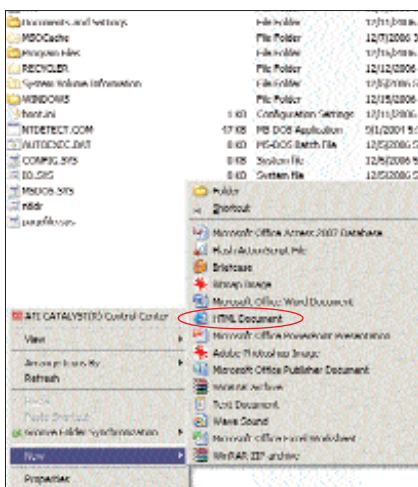
New "File > New"

In Explorer, when using the File > New option, or when right-clicking and selecting New, you get a list of files that you can create, including text documents, folders, images, sounds, Excel spreadsheets, etc. If you want to be able to make new items, such as HTML files or RTF documents, you will have to edit the Registry.

Open the Registry Editor and navigate to HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT. Here, find the extension of the file type you want to be able to create, such as .htm or .rtf, and then find the key called ShellNew. If the file type does not have a ShellNew key, create one.

Now, in the right-pane of the Registry Editor, create a new String value called NullFile. Now you need to close the Registry Editor and restart Windows.

The next time you right-click, you will be able to create a new file (.htm in our example) by selecting File > New. A zero byte file will be created, which you can then edit.



You can add various file types to the context menu in Explorer

Get Rid Of The Arrow

Shortcuts have an arrow, and it's irritating to a few people. If you want to remove the arrows, open the Registry Editor, navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Shell Icons. If this key does not exist, create it.

Now, create a new String value inside this key and name it "29". Set the value of this String value to "C:\Windows\System32\shell32.dll,52", which is basically an empty icon. Now close the Registry Editor and restart your computer to see the arrows disappear.

If you're doing something important, and don't want to restart just yet, you can force Windows to redraw all the icons by doing the following:

Right-click on the Desktop, select Properties. Now click on the Appearance tab and click Advanced.



Desktop icons: before, on the left, and after removing the arrows, on the right

From the drop-down list, choose icon, and change the value (the default is 32). Click OK and then Apply. Now go back and restore the value to 32 and click OK, Apply, and then OK. This will bring you back to your desktop, and you will find all those pesky arrows gone.

You can also replace the arrows with something else. Just change the path provided in the Registry hack mentioned earlier ("C:\Windows\System32\shell32.dll,50") to the path of the icon you want to use.

Prioritise

Have you ever been busy burning a dual-layer DVD master and had something stupid like a scheduled anti-virus scan create a very expensive coaster? No? Well, it's happened to us quite often, and it's probably happened to others who burn a lot of CDs or DVDs.

Of course, this isn't the only problem that occurs when Windows gets its priorities all wrong, but it is the most common.

Basically, every process (task) has its priority, according to which Windows chooses which process requires maximum love from the CPU. In order to make sure that some task that you feel is critical, which Windows may consider a low level task, gets the ideal CPU usage time, you will have to manually give it some importance.

Press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Esc] to open the Windows Task Manager. Now click on Processes to see the list of running processes. In order to change the priority of a running process, just right-click on the process, go to Set Priority, and select a level. The choices you have are Realtime, High, AboveNormal, Normal, BelowNormal and Low. These are pretty self-explanatory.

If you have a CD/DVD burning software that you want to give the highest importance to, set the burning software's process to have a High or Realtime priority. Now, hopefully, you should see your burner stop producing coasters.

Recycle The Recycle Bin

Some people are paranoid about how clean their desktops look, and would rather not have icons like My Computer, My Documents, etc. on it. Now removing these is easy—just right-click on the Desktop, select Properties > Desktop > Customize Desktop, and then uncheck all the boxes corresponding to the icons you don't want. But what about the Recycle Bin? This one's a tougher nut to crack.

Go to the Registry Editor, navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Desktop\NameSpace. Look for the key {645FF040-5081-101B-9F08-00AA002F954E} and delete it.

Of course, you may want to just rename the Recycle Bin instead of

deleting it altogether. In this case, you should navigate to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\ShellNoRoam\MUICache and change the value of @C:\WINDOWS\system32\shell32.dll,-8964 to whatever you want.

Look ma, No Recycle Bin!

